

Large intestine

The large intestine is about a quarter of the length of the small intestine, but twice its width. It receives watery waste from the small intestine and turns it into semisolid feces (poop).

Three parts

The cecum, colon, and rectum make up the large intestine. The longest section, the colon, travels up, across, and down the abdomen. It turns watery, undigested waste into feces by absorbing water back into the bloodstream.

The **cecum** is the first, short section of the large intestine

Transverse colon travels across the abdomen

Ascending colon rises up the abdomen

Descending colon passes down the abdomen

Junction between small and large intestines

Feces

The **appendix** sticks out from the cecum

Rectum stores feces ready for disposal

Anus opens for feces to leave the body

Each day, the average person passes enough wind (gas from the large intestine) to fill a party balloon.